BONUS GUIDE

Notion for beginners

Everything you need to feel at home in Notion and in your Second Brain, in 15 minutes.

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SystemForge

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Get set up

Five minutes, once.

1. **Create your Notion account** at notion.com (or log in). Use the same account on your computer and phone.
2. **Open your template link** and click **Duplicate** in the top right corner. Pick your workspace. The full Second Brain is now copied into your account.
3. **Get the apps.** Notion has apps for Mac, Windows, iPhone and Android. Everything syncs.
4. **Add it to your sidebar favorites.** Open the Second Brain home page, click ⭐ (top right). Do the same for 📱 **Mobile home** on your phone.
5. **Open Start here** in the menu and follow the steps. Keep the example data at first: it shows how everything links together.

> **Tip:** Turn on **Full width** (••• top right) on the home page. It gives your dashboard room to breathe.

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The 6 things to know

Blocks

Every line in Notion is a block: text, a checkbox, an image, a heading. Hover a block and drag ⋮⋮ to move it.

The / menu

Type **/** on any empty line to add anything: a heading, a to-do list, a toggle, a callout, an image.

Pages

A page can hold other pages, like folders. Every page can have an icon and a cover.

Databases

A list where every item is a page with fields (date, status, tags). Your Tasks, Notes and Projects are databases.

Views

The same data shown in different ways: table, board, calendar, gallery, list. Switch with the tabs above a database.

Relations

Links between databases. A task belongs to a project, a project to an area and a goal. That's how your progress bars work.

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Databases, simply

Your Second Brain has 10 databases. You'll use 4 of them every day.

Database	What goes in it	How often
🗒️ Notes	Ideas, links, quotes, meeting notes	Every day
✅ Tasks	Small next steps with a due date	Every day
✔️ Habits	One row per day, tick what you did	Every day
📓 Journal	A 2-minute check-in: mood, win, thanks	Every day
🚀 Projects	Things with a finish line	Every week
🎯 Goals	The big things you want this year	Every month
🧭 Areas	Parts of life you keep up (health, money…)	Every month
📚 Resources · 📖 Reading list · 🔁 Weekly reviews	Topics, books, your reviews	When needed

Add an item

Click **New** on a database, or the **+ New page** line at the bottom of a list.

Filter and sort

Use the filter and sort icons above a database. They only change the view, never your data.

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Your routine

☕ Every day · 5 min

☐ Capture ideas into **Notes** (use ⚡ Quick capture)

☐ Check 🔥 **Next 7 days** and do the first task

☐ Tick today's **habits**

☐ Write a 2-minute **journal** entry

🔁 Every week · 15 min

☐ Empty the 📥 **Inbox**: give each note a home

☐ Check projects **In progress** and your goals

☐ Pick the 3 most important tasks for next week

☐ Add a page in **Weekly reviews**

🗓️ Every month · 30 min

Open **Monthly review**: wins, lessons, an area check and your focus for next month.

🎆 Every year · 1–2 h

Open **Yearly review**: look back, score each area and set 3 goals for next year.

The golden rule: capture first, sort later. A rough note in the inbox beats a perfect note you never wrote.

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Make it yours

1. **Delete the example data** when you're ready. In a database, tick the box on the left of each row and press Delete. Start with Tasks and Notes, then Projects, Goals and Areas.
2. **Rename your habits.** Open Habits, click a column name (like 🏃 *Move*) and type your own.
3. **Change covers and icons.** Hover the top of any page and click **Change cover** or the icon.
4. **Set your areas.** Write one line in **Standard** for each: what “good” looks like for you.
5. **Save repeat pages as templates.** In a database, click the arrow next to **New** → **+ New template**. Great for your journal and weekly review.
6. **Turn on dark mode** if you like: Settings → Appearance.

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Shortcuts and fixes

Do this	Mac	Windows
Search everything	`⌘ + P`	`Ctrl + P`
New page	`⌘ + N`	`Ctrl + N`
Undo	`⌘ + Z`	`Ctrl + Z`
Show / hide sidebar	`⌘ + \`	`Ctrl + \`
Dark mode on / off	`⌘ + Shift + L`	`Ctrl + Shift + L`
Add any block	`Type / on an empty line`	

Something looks wrong?

I deleted something

Press undo right away, or open **Trash** in the sidebar to restore a page.

A view is empty

Check the filter icon above it. Some views only show this week or open items.

Need help? Send us a message where you bought this template. We read every message.